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Std VIII SOCIAL SCIENCE

SURE A GRADE NOTES

Europe on the World Map

1.Look at the world map and answer the following questions.

* Which continent is located to the east of Europe- Asia



* Which continent is located to the west of Europe- North America
* Which ocean is located to the north of Europe- Arctic ocean
* Which sea is located to the south of Europe- Mediterranean Sea

2.Why Europe is called Eurasia ?

₹ Europe is the sixth largest continent.

₹ While the other six continents are separate landmasses, Europe is seen as a western extension of Asia.

₹ The vast landmass that includes Asia and Europe is called Eurasia.

3.Europe has been considered as a continent since ancient times.Evaluate the statement

• Europe was considered as the centre of the world by the Greek and the Roman scholars.

•Europe was recorded as a continent on world maps made

• This is only by the Greeks and the Romans 2000 years ago.

4.Find the latitudinal and longitudinal extension of Europe

☞ Europe lies between the latitudes 35°N to 72°N and the longitudes 25°W to 65°E.

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Location of Europe

5.Give an account on Location of Europe

¢ Europe is bordered by the Arctic Ocean to the north, the Atlantic Ocean to the west, and the Mediterranean Sea to the south.

¢ The Ural Mountains, the Black Sea, and the Caspian Sea to the east separate Europefrom Asia.

Geographical Features

6.Europe has a diverse topography. what they are ?

✪ The topography of Europe can be classified as follows.

✪ North Western Highlands ✪ Central Uplands

✪ North European Plains ✪ Alpine Mountain system

7.Write a short note on North Western Highlands

◎ The high hills found in the North Western regions of Europe and the Scandinavian Plateau spread across Norway, Sweden, and Finland are the speciality of the North Western Highlands.

◎ Scandinavia is a popular destination for travellers with its snow-capped mountains, glaciers, fast-flowing rivers, beautiful forests, and lakes.

◎ Round-topped and gently sloping hills, formed as a result of long-term glaciation and weathering, are found in many places.

◎ Fjords, which are found on the Scandinavian coast, are another feature of this region.

8.Briefly explain North European Plains

₩ The North European Plains are located south of the North Western Highlands.

₩ It is also known as the Great European Plain.

₩ This plain extends from the Ural Mountains in the east to the Atlantic Ocean in the west.

₩ The plain has a fairly flat topography with small hills here and there.

₩ The North European Plain, which is very suitable for agriculture, was formed as a result of glacial deposits and by the alluvium deposits of the major rivers of Europe, the Volga, the Don, and the Dnieper.

₩ The Volga is the longest river in Europe.

₩ The steppes are the most widespread grassland in the North European Plain.

9.What is meant by Central Uplands

€ The Central Uplands are located to the south of the North European Plain.

€ This area of land, filled with small hills, valleys, and plateaus,

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stretches from Ireland in the west to Russia in the east.
€ The Rhine and Rhone rivers enrich this area with water.
10.The different landforms that make up the Central Uplands are listed below. Check the table and identify the countries in which each of them is located.

Major landforms of the Central Uplands	
Landforms	Country
Rhine Valley, Vosges Mountains, Jura Mountains, Central Massif Plateau	France
Ardennes Mountains	Belgium
Black Forest Mountains, Harz Mountains	Germany
Maseta Plateau	Spain
Bohemian Plateau	Czech Republic

11.Find out which countries have plateaus that are part of the Central Uplands and write down them.

$ France $ Spain $ Germany $ Czech Republic $ Belgium

12.Explain Alpine Mountain System

£ The Alpine Mountain System is a series of fold mountains with parallel ranges located south of the Central Uplands.
£ These mountain ranges extend from the Atlantic Ocean in the west to the Caspian Sea in the east.
£ The main Alpine mountain ranges are the Alps, the Caucasus, and the Carpathians.
£ Mount Elbrus in the Caucasus Mountains is the highest peak in Europe.

13.Complete the chart below regarding the topography of Europe.

Major topographic divisions of Europe			
North Western Highlands	North European Plains	Central Uplands	Alpine Mountain System
* Fjords * Scandinavian Plateau * High hills	* Steppes * glacial deposits and alluvium deposits	* small hills, valleys, and plateaus	* a series of fold mountains * Mount Elbrus

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Climate, Natural Vegetation and Wildlife

14.Write the factors influence the climate of an area

Latitude # Topography # Closeness of the ocean

15.Which is the only continent in the world without desert ?

Europe

16."Europe can be classified into several climatic regions based on its climate. Each climatic region has its own flora and fauna".Elucidate the statement.

§ **Arctic/Tundra Climate**-Arctic parts of Europe experience a tundra climate.

§ The Arctic/Tundra climate is characterised by short, cold summers and long, harsh winters.

§ While summer temperature rises to 10°C, winter temperatures drop from -25°C to -40°C.

§ There is no sunlight here for 5 to 6 months in winter.

§ We know how important sunlight is for the growth of plants.

§ Long nights, harsh winters, and precipitation in the form of ice prevent the growth of plants.

§ Due to this, only shrubs, lichens, and mosses that can withstand the cold generally grow in this climate.

§ The lack of vegetation in the tundra climate also affects the animal life here.

§ Only a few animals such as wolf, reindeer, polar bear, and Arctic hare with thick fur that can survive the cold, can be seen here.

Subarctic/Taiga Climate- It lies south of the tundra region.

§ Although the short summers are mild and warm, winters are as harsh as those in the Arctic climate.

§ Temperature is below 0°C for five to seven months of the year.

§ Precipitation in the taiga climate is generally in the form of snow.

§ The main vegetation of the taiga climate is evergreen forests with coniferous trees.

§ The main trees are pine and cedar.

§ Lynx, ermine, and silver fox are the prominent animals in the region.

Eastern European Climate- The eastern parts of Europe experience severe summers and extreme winters.

§ This climate is known as the Eastern European Climate.

§ Winter temperature often drops below 0°C.

§ Light rain fall is common in summer.

§ Due to the scanty rainfall and intense heat, large trees do not grow in

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areas experiencing this climate.

§ The steppes experience the Eastern European Climate. Antelope, wolf, and horse are animals.

Western European Climate- is characterised by severe winter, moderate heat, and rainfall throughout the year.

§ This Climate is experienced in the northwestern European countries of Britain, the Netherlands, Belgium, southern Norway, Denmark, western France, and northern Spain.

§ The presence of the Atlantic Ocean influences the climate here.

§ This Climate is suitable for plant growth.

§ Deciduous trees with strong wood and broad leaves are found here.

§ Examples of these are beech, elm, oak, birch, and ash.

§ Animals like squirrel, fox, hare, deer, and wolf are also found here.

Mediterranean Climate- Mediterranean climate is the climate experienced in the regions around the Mediterranean Sea.

§ Portugal, Spain, Italy, Greece, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Croatia, and southern France experience Mediterranean climate.

§ Mediterranean climate is characterised by hot, dry summers and cold, rainy winters.

§ This is a climate where trees and shrubs grow well.

§ Rosemary, lavender, olive, pine, orange, grape, and fig are the main plants.

§ Rare species of animals such as the Iberian lynx, Barbary macaque, Mouflon goat, Spanish imperial eagle, nuthatch are found in the Mediterranean region.

Society and People

17.Prepare a short note on Population

® Despite being the sixth largest continent by size, Europe ranks third globally in population after Asia and Africa.

® Russia is Europe's most populous country, followed by Germany, the United Kingdom, France, and Italy.

® Population distribution across Europe is uneven, with higher densities found in the continent's western, southern, and eastern regions.

18.Prepare a note on how the topography and climate of countries like Norway, Sweden, and Finland influence population density.

➢ Due to the geographical characteristics, the population and population density in the Scandinavian countries such as Norway, Sweden, and Finland are very low.

➢ The majority of the population in these countries lives in the coastal cities in the South.

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19.Identify the main factors that contribute to Europe's high immigration rate and its status as an industrially and agriculturally rich region.

⁂ Europe's linguistic diversity is driven by its varied topography, culture, and immigration.

⁂ Russian is the most widely spoken language, alongside German, French, Italian, English, and Spanish.

⁂ Immigration is a major cause of European population growth, with many migrants arriving from Africa, Central Asia, and South Asia seeking opportunities in the developed region.

⁂ Europe's status as a developed, industrially, and agriculturally rich area is attributed to its excellent climate, abundant natural resources, and advanced technology, which acts as the main draw for this migration.

20.Although regional diversity exists in agriculture, What farming types are mostly practised depending on the availability of land and population density ?

Intensive Farming	Extensive Farming	Mixed Farming
Two distinct farming types: one is an intensive method that utilizes advanced technology to increase production in densely populated areas; the second is Mediterranean cultivation, which thrives in Mediterranean climates and focuses mainly on crops like oranges, olives, and grapes.	Commercial, mechanized grain farming, which is practiced over vast areas of land, specifically in the steppes of northern Europe.wheat. Cereals;barley, corn, and oats are cultivating	A method of raising livestock along with crops.In western Europe. Cereals,vegetables,livestock are grown

Fishing

21.Fishing is a primary economic activity in Europe, as important as

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agriculture.Substantiate

⌘ proximity to the sea influences Europe's fishing industry.

⌘ Fishing is a major occupation in the countries of Norway, Denmark, and Poland, which are bordered by the North Sea, the North Atlantic Ocean, and the Arctic Ocean.

⌘ Cod, herring, salmon, halibut, and sea trout are abundant in these areas.

Industry

22.The Industrial Revolution led Europe to development.Complete the table on iron and steel industry, textile industry, and manufacturing sector

Industries	Countries
Iron	Germany,Russia,Turkey,Italy
Shipbuilding	Italy,France,Germany,Netherlands
Textiles	Italy,Germany,France,UK
Automobiles	Germany,Spain,Czech Republic,Slovakia

All the Very Best Dear Students

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